

Maternal-Newborn Safety: Magnesium Sulfate

Magnesium Sulfate is a central nervous system depressant used to prevent seizures in preeclampsia.

Therapeutic Level:

The therapeutic range is 4.0 to 7.0 mEq/L.

Monitoring for Toxicity:

Nurses must assess the client closely for signs of magnesium toxicity:

1. Absent deep tendon reflexes (DTRs) is usually the first sign of toxicity.
2. Respiratory rate less than 12 breaths per minute.
3. Urinary output less than 30 mL/hour, which leads to magnesium accumulation.
4. Severe hypotension or cardiac arrest.

If toxicity is suspected, stop the infusion immediately and administer the antidote, Calcium Gluconate.